

Microsoft for Startups Founders Hub — Application Guide for Datasec Technologies

Prepared by Wednesday · 2026-08-19 · companion to WED-116 (full research on the ticket)

Bottom line: the application is **self-service and free**, no investor backing needed. Realistic outcome for Datasec: **~US\$1,000 in Azure credits on approval, up to ~US\$5,000 after business verification**, each tranche valid ~12 months. The US\$150K tier requires investor affiliation — not applicable. **One gate decides everything: the company must be less than 7 years old.** Confirm Datasec's incorporation date before spending any time on the rest.

Eligibility checklist (all must hold)

Requirement	Datasec position
Company less than 7 years old	⚠ CONFIRM — the deciding question
Software product owned by the company	✓ NexusAI · CypherKey · myPKI — frame the application around these; keep client-delivery work (HPSM) out of the narrative (consultancies/agencies are excluded)
Privately held, for-profit; HQ in an Azure country	✓ Australia
Not Series C or later funded	✓
Under US\$350K lifetime free Azure credits (per company)	✓ per current records — Secuura's separate membership does not count against Datasec
Not gov / education / consultancy / crypto-mining	✓ if framed as a product company (see above)

Steps

1. **Choose the Microsoft account deliberately.** The credits arrive as an Azure sponsorship tied to the tenant behind the account you apply with. **Use a Datasec-controlled account and land the credits in a dedicated or dev tenant — never the corporate tenant** (email/SharePoint). The clean pattern is Secuura's: its Founders Hub lives in its own tenant.
2. **Have ready:** legal name (Datasec Technologies), ABN, website URL, a two-to-three sentence product description centred on the owned products, and (helpful for verification) the company LinkedIn page.
3. **Apply:** go to microsoft.com/startups and follow *Join / Apply* (the portal itself is foundershub.startups.microsoft.com). Sign in with the account from step 1 and complete the startup profile. Free; roughly 30–60 minutes.
4. **Submit.** The entry tier (~US\$1,000 Azure credits, ~12-month validity) is typically granted quickly — often within days, sometimes immediately.

5. **Complete business verification** inside the portal (company registration / domain verification) to unlock the higher self-service tier (~US\$5,000).
6. **Activate the sponsorship** into the chosen tenant when prompted. Track the balance at microsoftazureponsorships.com. Set a cost alert on day one — credits expiring or exhausting silently is the standard failure mode.
7. **Spend it where it counts:** the natural fit is the NexusAI / CypherKey dev and demo workloads in the agent-workable environment. Credits cover VMs, databases, storage, networking and AI services; they do **not** cover Azure Marketplace products, Microsoft 365, Dynamics or premium support.

Two cautions. (1) If Datasec is 7+ years old, this door is closed — the alternatives are Microsoft partner/ISV programmes, a different conversation. (2) Tier amounts above come from Microsoft's page plus current third-party guides; **confirm the exact figures shown inside the application flow before budgeting against them.**

Links

Programme home	microsoft.com/en-us/startups
Application portal	foundershub.startups.microsoft.com
Sponsorship balance tracker	microsoftazuresponsorships.com
Eligibility discussion (Microsoft Q&A)	learn.microsoft.com — Founders Hub eligibility
Independent 2026 guides used	klymentiev.com · creditforstartups.com · startupgatha.com

Wednesday · 2026-08-19 · Sources are the programme page plus third-party guides current to 2026; figures marked approximate where Microsoft's own page does not state them. Full research trail: WED-116.